Introduction

In Obergefell v. Hodges (2015), the Supreme Court of the United States ruled that gay marriage be applied to all of the states. Reaction to this Supreme Court decision was mixed, with some people praising the ruling while others staunchly opposed it. Those who opposed it did so on the basis of religious ground or the basis of states' rights in enacting these marriage laws. On the other hand, while those who praised the decision were happy about it, noted that this was just the beginning, as it does not protect LGBT individuals from discrimination in areas of daily life, such as employment or housing, nor does it dictate any other accommodations to be made for LGBT individuals (Hermann 2016). The reaction to the Supreme Court's decision allowing marriage between same-sex couples exemplifies the attitudes towards gay marriage and its divisive nature across the United States.

Reaction to the Supreme Court case shows the divisive nature of same-sex relationships in our modern society. With the passing of this case, there has been reaction through legislation. Many states such as Indiana, Mississippi, North Carolina, Georgia and many other states have tried to pass legislative laws that are deemed religious freedom laws. Many of these laws are designed so that people with religious beliefs can refuse service to someone who is LGBT.

Opposition toward these legislative pieces has been immense, with many deeming these laws unconstitutional. While this could possible seemed geared to only businesses, this also can apply to someone who works in the government. If an individual who works for the government do not morally believe in same-sex relationships, they can refuse to hand out a license. Many businesses speak out against these laws, and many threaten to move jobs and businesses out of the state if these bills pass and become laws.

Same-sex relationships are one of the most apparent and controversial social changes of modern times. With current ongoing battles not only socially, but also legally, it is important to study factors in society that can influence acceptance of social changes. With changes in recent times in regards to relationships and family structure (such as acceptance of interracial relationships), it is imperative to discuss how, and why, same-sex relationships will evolve into our society.

Literature Review

On the surface, it may seem like political ideology is the most important factor in deciding the acceptance one has towards acceptance of same-sex relationships, there could be many attributing factors. One such factor, arguably tied with political ideology, is religious identity and strength to that identity, gender, and also the contact an individual has with gay or lesbian individuals.

Religiosity. Religiosity can be a contributing factor for the acceptance of same-sex relationships in communities. Religiosity, for simplicity, will be defined for purposes in this study as whether or not individuals are religious, and the degree of their religious views. Religious opposition to the Supreme Court ruling has been met with ferocity, with many religious leaders calling for banning gay marriage, adoptions, and promoting traditional family values and marriage. Salka and Burnett (2012) found that when gay marriage was up to the states, that many factors influenced whether or not a person voted in favor of same-sex marriage. Among several demographic functions, it was found by Salka and Burnette (2012) that those with a higher religious indicator were found to be against gay marriage on the ballot measure. In studying those within the church, Walker (2012) found that those with a higher 'religious orientation' were more likely to be against gay marriage. Not only does Walker's study (2012)

provide anti-gay marriage stances on the basis of religious orientation, but also founds that older, males are more likely to have an anti-gay marriage position. Within the United States, many religious leaders still call for an overturning of the decision of the ruling making gay marriage legal, one begs the question of what sparks such a heavy debate on the national stage? One answer might be that many Christian Americans have Christian Nationalism and this often conflicts with modern issue, especially socially such as gay marriage (Whitehead and Perry 2015). This overlap of social identities causes conflict to occur, as many of these individuals overlap their religious identity and political identity. These individuals, Christian nationalists, were found to have a strong, negative relation to support for gay marriage. (Whitehead and Perry 2015). Not only did Whitehead and Perry (2015) find little support among Christian Nationalists for gay marriage, these individuals consider gays and lesbians as out-groups who threatened their sense of self and also provided a threat to the community. The literature for the relationship between religiosity and gay marriage strongly suggests that those with a higher degree of affiliation with relationship have a tendency to have more negative perceptions of gay marriage and are less accepting of same-sex relationships. The topic of religiosity could be complex as a contributing factor for acceptance of same-sex relationships, with different denominations having different levels of acceptance of same-sex relationships. However, the sample comes from Francis Marion University students, which is located in the southern United States. The southern portion of the United States has higher rates of religious identification in the country, especially with Evangelical Protestantism. Not only this, but Christianity is often referred as the majority religion of citizens of the United States. Since all of these studies focusing on religiosity mainly focused on Christianity, it is expected that those with a higher degree of religiosity will have a lower toleration for same-sex relationships.

Gender. Gender is yet another impact of how someone views gay individuals and their acceptance of same-sex relationships. As noted in the Religiosity Section, it was found that older, gay males had a more negative view of gay marriage more so than other individuals. It should be noted that while Walker's study was restricted to those within the church, these findings also find support with other literature concerning a relation between gender and acceptance of same-sex relationships. In studying younger males aged 15-19, it was found that a vast majority thought of gay sex as repulsive (Marsiglio 1993). While there is a definite distinction between gay sex and gay marriage, it was also discovered that 12% of males felt as if they could be friends with a gay male (Marsiglio 1993). According to Masiglio's study, it would not be logical to conclude that heterosexual males have an overall negative view of homosexual men, including marriage. Others in the literature strongly support that male heterosexuals have a negative view of literature. It may be important to note that while many men do display more negative and hostile attitudes of gay men than women do, it is an interesting specify that there were no gender differences displayed for lesbians (Kerns & Fine 1994). There are several possibly explanations for why gender influences attitudes displayed toward gays and lesbians. One reason could be perceptions of gender roles, in which traditional gender roles are broken more frequently for gay men (Kerns & Fine 1994). Herek (1988) also agrees that traditional gender roles play a part in shaping the differential attitudes by gender towards gay men, which is furthered by saying that this is caused by how the family views gender roles as well. Herek (1988) goes a bit further with this analysis finding that attitudes towards gay men is also shaped through accordance through perception of agreement a friend has with the individual's attitudes and that past interactions with gays and lesbians also contributes towards how the attitude towards gay men is shaped. The complexity of gender in how it shapes attitudes towards gays

and lesbians is exhaustive, but the literature overwhelmingly supports the notion that males are more likely to have negative attitudes towards gays and lesbians. None of the literature focuses on how gender molds the attitudes toward acceptance of same-sex relationships. Despite this, it is conclusive that those who have more negative views of gays and lesbians will hesitate in support gay marriage. Based upon the literature, it should be expected that gender will have an impact on attitudes towards acceptance of same-sex relationships, specifically with males have lower acceptance levels and females have higher tolerance levels.

Contact & Degree of Contact. As Herek (1988) pointed out, interactions one has with gay and lesbians can influence their attitudes towards them. Contact alone is not a variable enough sufficient to change attitudes towards gays and lesbians. Contact needs to be measured in degrees, such as a closer relationship yields a higher degree and a higher quality of contact than something such as an acquaintance. Many times in a gay or lesbian's life, contacts who are close to them may not realize or be fully aware of their sexuality. In many circumstances, this creates a situation known as 'coming out'. Herek and Glunt (1993) continued this study in a survey in which around one-third of people confirmed that a family or friend had discussed their homosexuality with them. Continuing with other trends seen in the literature, interpersonal contact with homosexuals was reported more often with young, females who are highly educated and liberal. Interestingly enough, it was reported that contact was a more powerful predictor of attitudes towards gays and lesbians than any other demographic or social psychological variable (Herek & Glunt 1993). Another study looks specifically at same-sex marriage, stating that personal contact is strongly predicted for same-sex marriage support (Merino 2013). Like the other variables in this study, contact is a complex variable when it comes to people. While it may be true that personal contact creates a more supportive environment for those in same-sex

relationships, religiosity can weaken its intensity (Merino 2013). One possible explanation for this occurrence could be that with the more personal contact one has with gays and lesbians, individuals have a more thorough, deeper understanding of life experiences these individuals encounter. Continuing on studying personal contact and shifting attitudes toward gay men, Herek and Capitanio (1996) reported that with more contact that their attitudes become more favorable towards gays, creating "more relationships, closer relationships, and receiving direct disclosure about another's homosexuality" (412). The study also suggests that there is a reciprocal relationship that occurs between contact and attitudes, effectively always bouncing off of each other (Herek and Capitano 1996). According to the literature, we would expect to find individuals who have a more consistent and closer relationship will exhibit more accepting attitudes towards same-sex relationships.

Hypotheses. Here are the collected hypotheses expected based upon review of the literature:

- ***Religiosity:*** Those who have a higher degree of religiosity will have lower attitudinal acceptance of same-sex relationships and marriage.
- ***Gender:*** There is a relationship between gender and attitudes towards same-sex relationships and marriage, with males displaying lower levels of acceptance and females displaying higher levels of acceptance.
- ***Contact:*** Individuals who maintain more consistent and closer personal relationships with gays/lesbians will have a higher levels of attitudinal acceptance of same-sex relationships and gay marriage, with those who have weaker and less ties being less accepting of same-sex relationships and marriage.

Methods

A survey instrument was used to gather data on attitudes towards same-sex relationships at Francis Marion University. The survey consisted of 25 questions, was self-administered, and was a paper and pencil survey. The design of the survey was cross-sectional and the sample consisted of 50 students at the University. The sample used was a convenient sample. A consent form was attached to the front of the survey, making sure respondents were aware that the survey was anonymous and that consent was voluntary. Research was conducted under Jessica Burke for Sociology 403 – Research Design and Analytics.

The survey was handed out within a time frame of a week. Since one of the independent variables is gender, classes with nearly 1:1 ratio of male to female were preferred. Dr. Natalie Johnson is a Political Science Professor who assisted by allowing her classes to distribute the surveys out. The first handout consisted of 21 surveys in Room 140A of Founders' Hall at Francis Marion University at 12:15 PM. The class that attends during this hour is Political Science 323 – Rights of the Accused. The next handout was done on April 1, 2016 at 9:30 AM. The same room was used for this handout in a Political Science 101 class, with 26 surveys being administered. The remaining three surveys were handed out in History 204 – European History Before the French Revolution at 12:30 PM. Data were entered into SPSS immediately after this collection.

Measurement of the independent variables include gender, religiosity, and contact were included in the survey. Gender was asked on survey item number 24 with "What is your gender?" with 1 being coded as male and 2 being coded as female. However, these would be dummy coded in the data file with 0 being male and 1 being female. This would make gender a nominal variable. Religiosity was used in a 5 series of questions on survey items 14-18 where

respondents were asked how important the following items were to them, with 1=not important and 10=very important. The statements were: (14) "Engaging in daily prayer"; (15) "Attending church services"; (16) "Participating/Volunteering in church activities"; (17) "Daily devotional studies"; and (18) "Being around those who share the same belief as me." The respondents simply wrote the number on a line next to these statements, making religiosity an interval-ratio scale variable. These numbers were added up and added as another variable labeled "Total Religiosity" and a Cronbach's Alpha Reliability Test was done (see table 1). Contact was measured on survey items 19 and 21. Survey item was a nominal level variable which asked: "I know acquaintances who identify as gay or lesbian." The answers were coded as 1=Yes, 2=No, 3=Not sure, and 4=Refuse. Response options 3 and 4 were considered missing variables. This variable was also dummy coded with 0=Yes and 1=No. Survey item 21 asked respondents on test their agreement with the following statement: "I have constant communication with someone who identifies as gay or lesbian." The response choices were as follows: 1=Strongly disagree, 2=Disagree, 3=Somewhat disagree, 4=Neutral, 5=Somewhat agree, 6=Agree, 7=Strongly Agree and 8=Refuse.

The dependent variable, acceptance of same-sex relationships, was measured using the first ten items on the survey. These items were true interval-ratio items where respondents filled in a blank beside each statement where it was asked how comfortably they would feel with certain situations. The respondents were told 1=very uncomfortable and 10=no discomfort and filled in the blank accordingly. The first 5 response items measured acceptance of male-same-sex relationships with the following statements: (1) "Two males having sweet talk (calling each other 'babe', 'honey', etc."; (2) "Two males holding hands in public space"; (3) "Two males kissing in public space"; (4) "Two males getting married"; and (5) "Two males adopting children.". The

remaining five survey items measured female same-sex acceptance with these same statements in their respective orders, except replacing two males with two females in each instance. Just as with religiosity, these survey items were added into three variables and a reliability test using Cronbach's alpha was run to ensure these variables could be used (see table 1). Survey items 1-5 were made into a new variable named total male same-sex acceptance and survey items 6-10 were made into a variable named total female same-sex acceptance. Another variable was also created measuring survey items 1-10 to measure total same-sex acceptance.

A few demographic questions were also asked on the survey that will potentially be used. These include age and race/ethnicity variables. Age was measured in survey item 23 where respondents answered on a line their age in response to the question: "What was your age on your last birthday?" This made the age variable an interval-ratio level variable. Race/ethnicity was measured with survey item 25 asking "What is your race/ethnicity?" Response options were 1=White/Caucasian, 2=Black/African American, 3=Hispanic, 4=Asian, and 5=Other. These variables would also become dummy variables with 0=White/Caucasian and 1=Black/African American, and the other response options were coded as missing due to the small sample size.

Table 1. Cronbach's Alpha Test

Variable Measured	**Cronbach's Alpha Score**
Male Same-Sex Acceptance (1-5)	.934
Female Same-Sex Acceptance (6-10)	.923
Total Same-Sex Acceptance (1-10)	.960
Total Religiosity (14-18)	.951

Indexing these variables and conducting a reliability test shows that these variables can be used in statistical analysis, as anything above a .650 is considered decent to excellent. Since these variables exist way above this threshold, their reliability is deemed to be fit for statistical analyses.

Results

Descriptive Statistics

Table II. Mean Tables

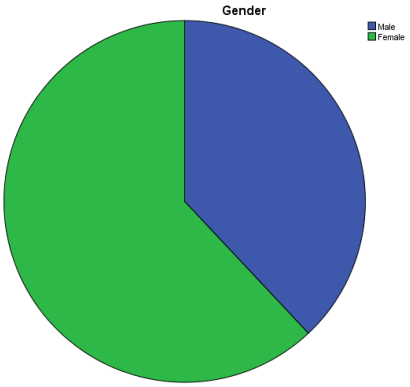
Survey Item	Mean Values
Degree of comfort with two males having sweet talk.	6.4 / 10
Degree of comfort with two males holding hands in public.	6.72 / 10
Degree of comfort with two males kissing in public.	4.96 / 10
Degree of comfort with two males getting married.	6.86 / 10
Degree of comfort with two males adopting children.	6.70 / 10
Total Male Same-Sex Relationship Acceptance	**31.64 / 50**
Degree of comfort with two females having sweet talk.	7.3 / 10
Degree of comfort with two females holding hands in public.	7.65 / 10
Degree of comfort with two females kissing in public.	6.12 / 10
Degree of comfort with two females getting married.	7.14 / 10
Degree of comfort with two females adopting children.	6.98 / 10
Total Female Same-Sex Relationship Acceptance	**35.10 / 50**
Total Same-Sex Acceptance	**66.74 / 100**
Importance of engaging in daily prayer.	7.62 / 10
Importance of attending church services.	6.60 / 10
Importance of participating/volunteering in church activities.	5.80 / 10
Importance of daily devotional studies.	5.88 / 10
Importance of being around those who share same religious belief.	5.44 / 10
Total Degree of Religiosity	**31.27 / 50**
Age	20.92

The above table shows the mean values for these questions. For every situation concerning acceptance of same-sex relationships, females had higher numbers than every identical survey item that was posed for male same-sex acceptance. This shows in the mean values for the totals, with female same-sex relationship acceptance having a mean value of nearly 4 over the male same-sex relationship acceptance. Interestingly enough, for male same-sex acceptance, the highest mean value came from two males getting married. The same was not true for females, with their highest mean value coming from two females holding hands in public. For both male and female, the lowest values came from two (fe)males kissing in public. The worst mean value, acceptably, came from the two males kissing in public. Different from the way the literature

review was setup, the hypotheses were conducted so that the nominal-only variable (gender) would be conducted first, with religiosity and contact following in those respective orders.

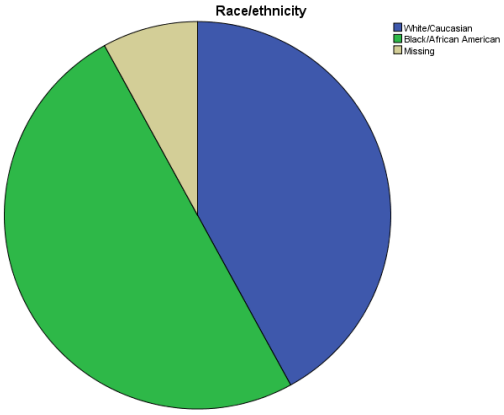
Demographics

Pie Chart 1. Percentage of Male and Female.



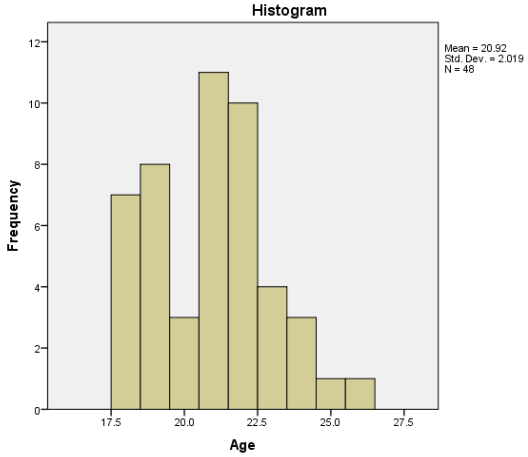
Male	Female
38%	62%

Pie Chart 2. Percentage of White and Black.



White	Black	Missing
42%	50%	8%

Histogram 1. Age



For demographics, 38% of the respondents were male, while 62% of the respondents were female. A more even distribution of male and female was preferred, but the sample was skewed more in favor of females. Race was close, with exactly half of the respondents being "Black/African American" and 42% of the respondents being "White/Caucasian". The 8% of the missing comes from 2% "Hispanic" (n=1) and "Other" being 6% (n=3). The age reflects the convenient sample that was used, with the mean age being 20.12. No respondents in the survey were over the age of 27. All of this numbers are aligned with expectations due to the sample used.

I. Gender and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. The independent variable, gender, would be measured nominally and the dependent variable, acceptance of male same-sex relationships, is measured by means of interval-ratio level variables. Appropriate statistics conducted would be crosstabs, chi-square, and eta. However, due to the indexing of the dependent variable, overall total acceptance of male-same sex relationships, crosstabs were conducted, but not included in the table. Results for chi-square and eta are in Table 1a.

Table 1a. Chi-Square and Eta: Gender & Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships

Chi-square	28.542
Eta	.223

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The chi-square value is 28.542 and the eta is .223. The p-value ended up as .158. Therefore, the association between gender and acceptance of male same-sex relationships is not significant. The eta value suggests a weak association between gender and acceptance of male same-sex relationships, which is expected due to there being no significance.

b. Multivariate analysis. For multivariate analysis, an independent t-test and multiple regression were used. An independent t-test was done because gender is a nominal variable. For multiple regression, age and race/ethnicity were used as control variables. Table 1b shows the independent t-test results and Table 1c shows the multiple regression.

Table 1b. Independent t-test: Gender and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships.

	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	t-value	df
Male	19	27.11	17.754	-1.584	48
Female	31	34.42	14.585		

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The t-value ended up being -1.584. The t-test shows that there is not a significant difference between male and female in terms of the mean values of acceptance of male-same sex relationships (p=.120).

Table 1c. Multiple Regression: Gender and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships.

	b
Gender	3.578
Age	-1.289
Race/ethnicity	7.374
Constant	53.014
R-squared	.147

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The r-squared value in this case ended up being .147, meaning that gender, age and race/ethnicity explain 14.7% of the variance in acceptance of male same-sex relationships. Females have higher levels of acceptance of male same-sex relationships (3.578). Recall that males were coded 0 and females were coded 1. However, relationship between gender and acceptance of male same-sex relationships is not significant (p=.574). Age and acceptance of male same-sex

relationships has a negative relationship. For each unit increase in age, acceptance of male same-sex relationships decreases by 1.289. The relationship between age and acceptance of male same-sex relationships is not significant (p=.329). In terms of race/ethnicity, whites were coded as 0 and blacks were coded as 1. Because of this, blacks have higher levels of acceptance of male same-sex relationships (b=7.374). Again, the relationship between race/ethnicity was not significant with a p-value of .182.

II. Gender and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. Just as with gender and acceptance of male same-sex relationships, the independent variable is gender and the dependent variable in this case would be acceptance of female same-sex relationships. The same statistical analysis will be used here as with those variables: crosstabs, chi-square and eta. Again, due to the indexing of the survey items measuring female same-sex relationship acceptance, the crosstabs were conducted, but not included due to their significant length. Table 2a shows the results for chi-square and eta.

Table 2a. Chi-Square and Eta: Gender & Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

Chi-Square	30.051
Eta	.120

p<.001***
P<.01**
P<.05*
P<.10*

The chi-square value ended up as 30.051. There was no statistical significance in the association between gender and acceptance of female same-sex relationships, with a p-value of .148. Keeping that in mind, the eta value (.120) shows a weak association between gender and acceptance of female same-sex relationships.

b. Multivariate Analysis. Similarly to section 1b, multivariate analysis here will also include an independent t-test and a multiple regression test, with age and race/ethnicity again being controls. Gender again will be the independent, nominal variable and the dependent variable being acceptance of female same-sex relationships, which is an interval-ratio level variable. The independent t-test is shown in Table 2b and the multiple regression test in Table 2c.

Table 2b. Independent t-test: Gender and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	t-value	df
Male	19	32.84	16.150	-.838	48
Female	31	36.48	14.130		

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The t-value was -.838. The t-test showed that there was no significant difference between male and females in acceptance of female same-sex relationships (p=.406).

Table 2c. Multiple Regression: Gender and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

	b
Gender	.507
Age	-1.107
Race/ethnicity	7.319
Constant	53.590
R-squared	.111

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Gender, age, and race/ethnicity explain 11.1% of the variance in acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Females have higher levels of acceptance of female same-sex relationships (b=.507). The relationship between gender and acceptance of female same-sex relationships is not significant (p=.930). Between age and acceptance of female same-sex relationships there is a negative relationships. For each unit increase in age, acceptance of female same-sex relationship

decreases by 1.107. The relationship between age and acceptance of female same-sex relationships is not significant (b=.357). In terms of race, blacks again have higher levels of acceptance for female same-sex relationships. This relationship is also not significant (b=.146).

III. Religiosity and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. The independent variable in this case would be religiosity, with the dependent variable being acceptance of male same-rex relationships. Religiosity was measured exactly like the acceptance of male-same sex relationships. Both of these variables in the survey were measured using 5 true interval-ratio level variables, with each being indexed into new variables, such as total acceptance of male same-sex relationships and total degree of religiosity, respectively. Both the independent and dependent variables were interval-ration, making a pearson r the more appropriate statistical test to conduct. Table 3a shows the results of the pearson r test.

Table 3a. Pearson r: Religiosity and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships.

	Total Male Same-Sex Acceptance
Total Degree of Religiosity	.223

p<.001***
p<.01**
P<.05*
P<.10*

The pearson r ended up being a value of .233 and the p-value ended up being .120. While the result of the pearson r is not significant due to the p-value, the results are quite contrary to what was hypothesized. According to the pearson r, there is a positive, weak association between religiosity and acceptance of male same-sex relationships. Due to the p-value, this result was not significant.

a. Multivariate Analysis. Since both religiosity and acceptance of male same-sex relationships were interval-ratio level variables, only multiple regression will be used in this

process. The control variables will be age and race/ethnicity. Results for the multiple regression are in Table 3c.

Table 3c. Multiple Regression: Religiosity and Acceptance of Male-Same Sex Relationships

	b
Total Degree of Religiosity	-.170
Age	-1.919*
Race/ethnicity	10.862*
Constant	72.280
R-squared	.204

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Religiosity, age, and race/ethnicity explain 20.4% of the variance in acceptance of male same-sex acceptance. Religiosity and acceptance of male same-sex relationship have a negative relationship, meaning those who are more religious have lower levels of acceptance for male same-sex relationships. This relationship was not significant (p=.265). As noted in gender, the relationship between age and race/ethnicity are the same (as age increases, acceptance of relationships decrease; blacks have higher levels of acceptance), but the b values are different. For every unit increase in age, acceptance for male same-sex relationship decreases 1.919. Unlike in gender, in degree of religiosity both age and race/ethnicity become statistically significant. Age is significant at the .10 alpha level (p=.096) and race/ethnicity is significant at the .05 alpha level (p=.026). Therefore both age and race/ethnicity predict acceptance of male same-sex relationships.

IV. Religiosity and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. Just as with religiosity and acceptance of male same-sex relationships, religiosity and acceptance of female same-sex relationships were both measured using the same technique, except different survey items measured acceptance of female same-sex

relationships. The independent variable this time will be religiosity and the dependent variable is the acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Since both of the variables were measured as interval-ratio level variables, a pearson r will be run again. The results for the pearson r are shown in Table 4a.

Table 4a. Pearson r: Religiosity and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

	Total Female Same-Sex Acceptance
Total Degree of Religiosity	.120

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Yet again, the pearson r is contrary to what is hypothesized. The pearson r tells us there is a positive, weak correlation between degree of religiosity and acceptance of female same-sex relationships. However, the pearson r result again is not statistically significant, with a p-value of .406.

b. Multivariate Analysis. Just as in Section III, another multiple regression test will be done. This time, however, it will test acceptance of female same-sex relationships against degree of religiosity. Again, control variables will be age and race/ethnicity. Results for this multiple regression are in Table 4b.

Table 4b. Multiple Regression: Religiosity and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships.

	b
Total Degree of Religiosity	-.184
Age	-1.348
Race/ethnicity	9.418*
Constant	63.922
R-squared	.179

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Religiosity, age, and race/ethnicity explain 17.9% of the variance in acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Just as in section 3, religiosity and acceptance of female same-sex relationships have a negative relationship; again, this means more religious individuals have lower levels of acceptance for female same-sex relationships. This relationship is not significant (p=.187). Age again remains the same, with a negative relationship with acceptance of female same-sex relationship. For every unit increase in age, acceptance for female same-sex relationship decreases 1.348. Unlike in the multivariate section (males) of Section 3, the relationship between age and female same-sex is not significant (p=.194). Blacks again have higher levels of acceptance for female same-sex relationship and this relationship is significant at the .05 alpha level (p=.033); therefore race/ethnicity predicts acceptance of female same-sex relationships.

V. Amount of Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. The survey item used in this analyses will be survey item 19, asking if the respondents knew someone who identified as gay or lesbian, with yes or no response options, with the others being categorized as missing. This makes this contact survey item a nominal level variable, and also being the independent variable. As usual, acceptance of male same-sex relationships is the dependent variable. Due to this, the appropriate statistical tests to use would be crosstabs, chi-square, and eta. Just as before, crosstabs were conduct but left alone due to indexing. Table 5a will show the chi-square and eta results.

Table 5a. Chi-Square and Eta: Amount of Contact and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships

Chi-Square	16.727
Eta	.042

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The chi-square has a value of 16.726, with the eta being .042. The p-value in this case was .778, showing no statistical significance. The eta value shows a weak association between contact and acceptance of male same-sex relationships.

b. Multivariate Analysis. Since survey item number 19 (contact) was a nominal level variable, a t-test will be run in conjunction with a multiple regression test. The controls will be age and race/ethnicity. The results for the independent t-test is in Table 5b and the results for the multiple regression is in Table 5c.

Table 5b. Independent t-test: Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships (Know acquaintances who identify as gay or lesbian?)

	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	t-value	df
Yes	44	32.20	16.107	.285	46
No	4	29.75	20.982		

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The t-value here was .285. There is not a significant difference between degree of contact and acceptance of male same-sex relationships (p=.777)

Table 5c. Multiple Regression: Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships (Know acquaintances who identify as gay or lesbian?)

	b
Contact	5.121
Age	-1.679
Race/ethnicity	9.176*
Constant	62.323
R-squared	.139

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Contact, age, and race/ethnicity explain 13.9% of the variance in acceptance of male same-sex relationships. Those who have contact have lower levels of male same-sex relationships. . The

relationship between contact and acceptance of male same-sex relationships is not significant (p=.600).Contact and age have a negative relationship, meaning that every unit increase in age decreases acceptance of male same-sex relationships by 1.679. The relationship between age and contact is not significant (p=.167). Blacks also have higher amounts of acceptance of male same-sex relationships. This relationship is significant (p=.072) at the .10 alpha level. This means that race predicts acceptance of male same-sex relationships.

VI. Amount of Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. The same contact question was posed here, except this time it applies to acceptance of female same-sex relationships, the dependent variable. The independent variable again is contact, which is also a nominal variable. Because of this, chi-square and eta tests were conduct. Crosstabs were again, conducted, but are not shown. Table 6a shows the results for the chi-square and eta.

Table 6a. Chi-square and eta: Amount of Contact and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

Chi-Square	25.745
Eta	.114

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The chi-square has a value of 25.754. The eta has a .114, which shows a weak association between contact and acceptance of female same-sex relationships. The p-value (.216) explains that weak association, as there is no statistical significance in this association.

b. Multivariate Analysis. Exactly like acceptance for male same-sex relationships, acceptance will also run both an independent t-test and multiple regression analysis. The independent t-test will be Table 6b and the multiple regression will be Table 6c.

Table 6b. Independent t-test: Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships (Know acquaintances who identify as gay or lesbian?)

	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	t-value	df
Yes	44	35.91	14.886	.777	46
No	4	29.75	20.982		

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The t-value is .777. There is not a significant difference between degree of contact and acceptance of female same-sex relationships (p=.441).

Table 6c. Multiple Regression: Contact (#19) and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships (Know acquaintances who identify as gay or lesbian?)

	b
Contact	1.401
Age	-1.109
Race/ethnicity	8.062*
Constant	53.683
R-squared	.113

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Contact, age, and race/ethnicity explain 11.1% of the variance in acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Those who have contact have lower levels of acceptance of female same-sex acceptance. The relationship between contact and acceptance of female same-sex relationship is not significant (p=.874). As usual, age and acceptance of female same-sex relationship have a negative relationship, which is not significant (p=.312). Blacks still hold out, making their acceptance levels higher for accepting female same-sex marriage. The relationship is still significant at the .10 alpha level, meaning race/ethnicity predict acceptance of female same-sex relationships.

VII. Amount of Contact (#21) and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships.

a. Bivariate Analysis. Contact was tested again, this time under a different survey item. Recalling from earlier, survey item 21 was an interval-ratio level variable. Answers choices were on a likert scale, ranging from strongly agree to strongly disagree on agreeing with the statement: "I have constant communication with someone who identifies as gay or lesbian." This again will make contact the independent variable and the dependent variable will be acceptance of male same-sex relationships. Since both are interval-ratio level variables, a pearson r test was conduct. The results of this pearson r test is in Table 7a.

Table 7a. Pearson r: Amount of Contact and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships.

	Total Male Same-Sex Acceptance
Constant Communication with same-sex individual	.380*

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

For survey item 21, contact and acceptance of male same-sex relationships had a value of .380. This means that there is a positive, moderate correlation between amount of contact and acceptance of same-sex relationships. The relationship also comes out statically significant at alpha level .05, with the p-value being .027.

b. Multivariate Analysis. For this multivariate analysis, only multiple regression is needed since survey item 21 is an interval-ratio level variable and acceptance of male same-sex relationships is also interval-ration. The control variables will still be age and race/ethnicity. Multiple regression for these variables will be in Table 7b.

Table 7b. Multiple Regression: Contact (#21) and Acceptance of Male Same-Sex Relationships (Constant Communication with someone who identifies as gay or lesbian)

	b
Contact	1.546
Age	-2.956*
Race/ethnicity	5.475
Constant	84.320
R-squared	.255

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Contact (constant communication), age, and race/ethnicity explain 25.5% of the variance in acceptance of male same-sex relationships. Unlike with the other contact question, this says that those who have higher levels of contact have higher levels of male same-sex relationships.. The relationship between contact (constant communication) and acceptance of male same-sex relationship is not significant (p=.307). Age continues to see the same trend (a negative relationship with acceptance), where there is a unit increase in age, acceptance of male same-sex relationship drops by 2.956. The relationship between age and acceptance of male same-sex relationship is significant at the .05 alpha level (p=.042). Meaning age will determine acceptance of male same-sex relationships with contact controlled for. Blacks also continue to have the same trend with higher levels of acceptance, but this time there is no significance (p=.325).

VIII. Amount of Contact (#21) and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships

a. Bivariate Analysis. Analysis was conducted again on survey item 21, this time measuring acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Both survey items again are interval-ratio level variables, with the independent and dependent variables being the same (except now it is female acceptance). Another pearson r test was conducted, with the results shows in Table 8a.

Table 8a. Pearson r: Amount of Contact and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships.

	Total Male Same-Sex Acceptance
Constant Communication with same-sex individual	.346*

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

The pearson r (.346) again shows a positive, moderate association; this time, that correlation exists between contact and acceptance of female same-sex relationships. This correlation is also statistically significant at the .05 alpha level (p=.045).

b. Multivariate Analysis. The same test, multiple regression, will be done with female acceptance, just like in section 7 with the controls and everything else being exactly alike. This multiple regression test between contact (constant communication) and female acceptance of same-sex relationships will be Table 8b.

Table 8b. Multiple Regression: Contact (#21) and Acceptance of Female Same-Sex Relationships (Constant Communication with someone who identifies as gay or lesbian)

	b
Contact	1.550
Age	-2.119*
Race/ethnicity	3.442
Constant	71.402
R-squared	.230

p<.001***
p<.01**
p<.05*
p<.10*

Contact (constant communication), age, and race/ethnicity explain 23% of the variance in acceptance of female same-sex relationships. Just like with male same-sex acceptance, this shows that those who have more communication with gay or lesbians individuals also has higher levels of female same-sex relationships. The relationship between contact (constant communication) and acceptance of female same-sex relationships is not significant (p=.213). Just like the previous model with male acceptance, female acceptance and age have a negative

relationship. A unit increase in age will result in a 2.119 decrease in acceptance of female same-sex relationships. The relationship between age and female acceptance is significant at the .10 level (p=.072). Race/ethnicity has a lower number this time around, but blacks still have higher levels of acceptance. This relationship is not significant here either, just like in the previous model (p=.448).

Discussion & Conclusion

Almost none of the hypothesis were correct according to the results. The only significant results were for the contact portion. The results for the contact question (for constant communication) were significant at the .05 alpha level for both male and female same-sex relationship acceptance. However, they were only significant at the bivariate (using pearson r) analysis, as the multivariate results (multiple regression) did not show significance in either male or female same-sex relationship acceptance. However, an interest result also come from contact through question 19. The results for having knowing someone who identifies as gay or lesbian (yes or no) resulted in those who did not know someone who identified as gay or lesbian had higher levels of acceptance for both male and female same-sex relationships. This may be in part due to the skewed representation in the sample, with 44 choosing yes and only 4 choosing no. An outlier in someone who chose having high levels of acceptance of same-sex relationship possibly caused such a result to occur. Even though this was potentially the case, the results for this relationship was not significant.

One limitation for this study was certainly a small sample size. Many results came close to becoming significant, and if a bigger sample sized was used, it is rational to believe that many results would have become significant. Another suggestion for a different measure for contact would also be appriorpiate. Due to the skewness of the knowing someone who identifies as gay

or lesbian, the survey design could have imposed a more specific question in identify just how much contact respondents have with these individuals. And even then, those who have higher levels of acceptance may feel more free and welcoming to befriend gay or lesbian individuals, while those with lower levels of acceptance may be less likely and more hesitant to befriend gays or lesbians. A way to discover and measure this relationship would also be ideal.

With the recent Supreme Court decision, the political landscape has drifted into opposition and resistance to this measure. It is important to discuss these findings as it is imperative to the current social changes of the modern day. Future research should include branching out and having a bigger, more diverse sample. This study simply focused on an individual college with similar characteristics (such as age and being located in the Deep South). Conducting a more diverse study with higher differences in age and religiosity would be best to find these relationships and possibly finding relationships with new variables and acceptance of same-sex relationships. This is the modern day civil rights movement and it is important to continue dialogue in today's political environment with very heated debates about this social topic.

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